Mashrabeya

Possibly late-Mamluk to mid-Ottoman (9th-12th centuries AH / 15th-18th centuries CE)

Wood

W: 232 cm; H: 229 cm

Hall 3

Inv. no. 596

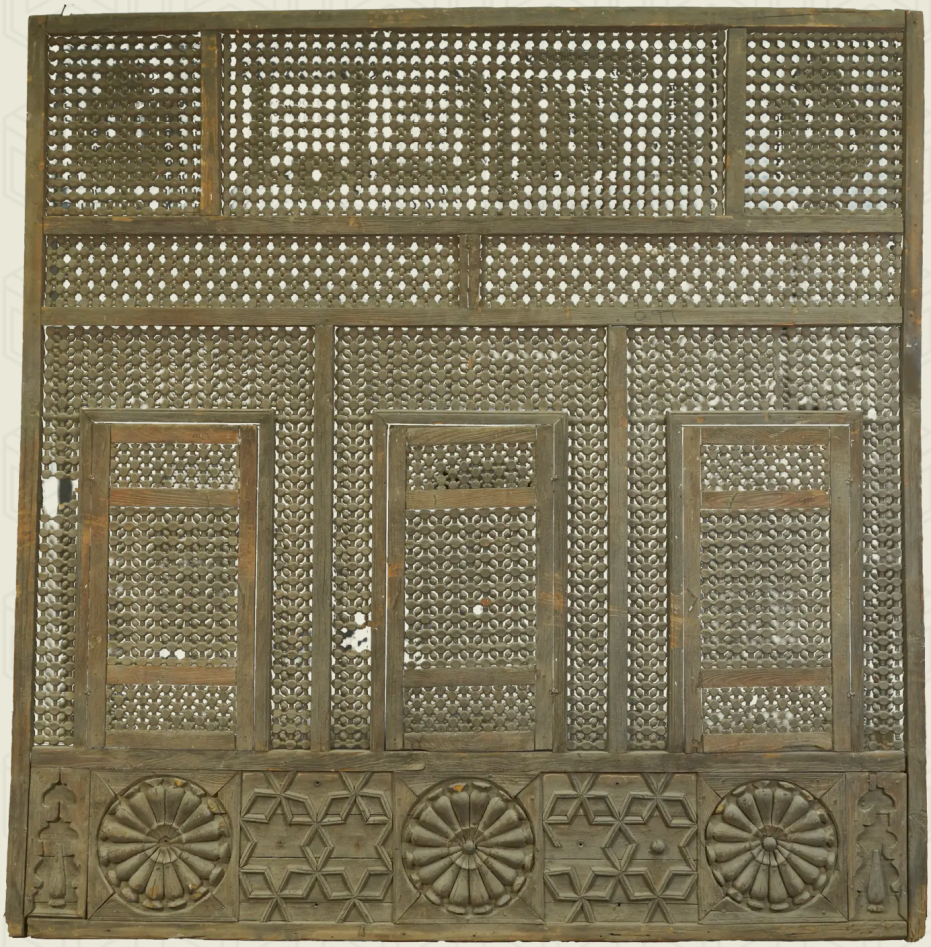


Lathe-turned mashrabeya with an upper panel centred on an inscription invoking praise of the divine, flanked by paired candle motifs and, at the outer edges, by two abriq ewers with prominent spouts and handles. Three internal openings are fitted with sliding shutters that move upward and are secured by a stop-peg mechanism characteristic of Ottoman woodwork.



The front of the Mashrabeya © NADIM Foundation

The reverse of the screen is ornamented along its base with an alternating sequence of three large rosettes and six-pointed stars, flanked on either side by a series of connected polylobed forms. The rosette segments, locally known as firaan (lit. “rats”), are not carved but lathe-turned, produced as complete elements and subsequently split in half. The range of wood-turning techniques and compositions brought together in this screen reflects the craftsman’s inventive manipulation of form, enabling a nuanced modulation of light and shadow and the richly dappled visual effects characteristic of mashrabeya interiors.



The back of the Mashrabeya © NADIM Foundation



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